Icons of the Faith

Quick Reference — All 36 Icon-Meaning Pairs

#		ICONOGRAPHIC ELEMENT	THEOLOGICAL MEANING
COLOURS			
1	🌟	**Gold Background**	Represents divine light and the uncreated glory of God
2	🔵	**Blue Garments**	Represents heaven and the heavenly kingdom
3	🔴	**Red Garments**	Represents divinity or martyrdom
4	⬜	**White Garments**	Represents purity and resurrection
FACIAL FEATURES			
5	👀	**Large Eyes**	Spiritual sight — seeing beyond the visible world
6	🤐	**Small Mouth**	The discipline of silence and prayer
7	👤	**Frontal Gaze**	The saint is present with you, looking at you
19	💧	**Tears on the Cheek**	The gift of holy compunction — weeping for love of God
20	👁️	**Elongated Nose**	The saint breathes the fragrance of heaven, not the world
GESTURES			
8	🖐	**Blessing Hand**	The hand raised in the sign of the cross to bless
9	🙌	**Open Palms Upward**	The posture of prayer and surrender to God
10	🙏	**Hand Over Heart**	Intercession — the saint prays for you
18	✌️	**Two Fingers Raised**	IC XC — the name of Jesus Christ in abbreviation
OBJECTS HELD BY SAINTS			
11	✝	**Cross Held in Hand**	Victory over death through Christ
12	📜	**Scroll or Book**	The saint is a teacher or evangelist
13	🌴	**Palm Branch**	The saint is a martyr — they won the victory
14	👑	**A Crown**	The crown of life given to the faithful
15	💨	**A Censer**	The saint serves in the liturgy — priesthood
16	📖	**The Gospel Book**	The Word of God proclaimed
17	💡	**A Halo (Nimbus)**	The saint dwells in God's light and glory
29	⚔	**A Sword**	The Word of God that cuts and defends — spiritual warfare
32	🔑	**Keys**	Authority given to St. Peter — the keys of the kingdom
36	🏆	**A Chalice**	The Eucharist — the Blood of Christ given for life
THE THEOTOKOS			
21	👶	**Christ Child on Lap**	The Theotokos bears the Incarnate Word to the world
22	⭐	**Three Stars on the Theotokos**	Virgin before, during, and after the birth of Christ
CREATURES AND SYMBOLS			
23	🔥	**Flames or Fire**	The presence of the Holy Spirit or divine zeal

#		ICONOGRAPHIC ELEMENT	THEOLOGICAL MEANING
24	🦁	**A Lion**	Symbol of St. Mark the Evangelist
25	🦅	**An Eagle**	Symbol of St. John the Evangelist — soaring vision
26	🐂	**An Ox**	Symbol of St. Luke the Evangelist — sacrifice
27	👼	**A Winged Man**	Symbol of St. Matthew the Evangelist — Christ's humanity
28	🕊️	**A Dove**	The Holy Spirit descending — peace and purity
30	🐟	**A Fish**	ICHTHYS — Jesus Christ, Son of God, Saviour
31	🌸	**A Lily or Lotus**	Purity and the Resurrection — new life from the waters
33	⚓	**An Anchor**	Hope that holds firm — the soul's anchor in Christ
34	🕷️	**A Dragon Underfoot**	The saint has conquered evil through Christ's power
35	😷	**Wounds or Stigmata**	Sharing in the sufferings of Christ

"He is the image of the invisible God, the firstborn over all creation." — Colossians 1:15